

recruiting hired swords

This section introduces Hired Swords – professional mercenaries – to Mordheim campaign games. Taverns in the settlements and shanty towns around Mordheim are good recruitment centres for warriors who do not belong to any particular warband or retinue, but instead hire out their services to the highest bidder.

A player can recruit Hired Swords when he creates his warband, or during the campaign phase after a game.

Hired Swords do not count towards the maximum number of warriors or Heroes a warband may have on its roster and don't affect your income from selling wyrdstone. However, Hired Swords do count as part of the warband for purposes of Rout tests, etc whilst in battle. A player cannot buy extra weapons or equipment for a Hired Sword, and he cannot sell the Hired Sword's weapons or equipment. To reflect their rarity, you can only have one of each type of Hired Sword in your warband. You may not use the Leadership of any of the Hired Swords for Rout tests.

hire fee

When a warband recruits a Hired Sword, you must must pay his *hire fee*. Subsequently, after each battle he fights, including the first, you must pay his *upkeep fee* if you want him to remain with the warband. If the Hired Sword is killed, or you no longer require his services, you don't have to pay any upkeep! These costs are indicated in the entries for each Hired Sword.

The money paid to Hired Swords comes from the warband's treasury in the same way as buying new weapons or recruiting new warriors. If you don't have enough gold to pay for the Hired Sword, or want to spend it on other things, he leaves the warband. Any experience he has gained will be lost, even if you hire a new Henchman of the same type.

injuries

If a Hired Sword goes *out of action* during the game, roll for his injuries as you would roll for a Henchman after a battle (i.e, 1-2 = Lost; 3-6 = Survives).

hired swords and experience

Hired Swords gain experience in exactly the same way as Henchmen. Refer to the scenarios to find out how much experience Hired Swords gain after each game.

Write the name and profile of a Hired Sword on your roster sheet in one of the Henchman group slots.

Once the Hired Sword gains enough experience for an advance, roll on the Heroes Advancement table (as opposed to Henchmen) to determine which advance he gains. Skills available to the Hired Swords are listed under their entries.

Pit fighter

30 gold crowns to hire +15 gold crowns upkeep

Pit Fighters are dangerous men who make their living in the illegal fighting pits of the Empire. Many of them are slaves and prisoners but some are free men who earn their living from savage pit fights in settlements like Cutthroat's Haven or Black Pit. Even though pit fights are banned in many provinces, they are very popular and a great deal of money is wagered on the outcome. Thus many authorities turn a blind eye to these bloodsports.

When not in the pits, Pit Fighters offer their services to the highest bidders, and they readily find employment in warbands intent on exploring the ruins of Mordheim. Pit Fighters are powerful and dangerous fighters, and their unique weaponry gives them an advantage against almost any opponent.

May be Hired: Any warband apart from Undead and Skaven may hire a Pit Fighter.

Rating: A Pit Fighter increases the warband's rating by +22 points, plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Pit Fighter	4	4	3	4	4	1	4	2	7

Equipment: Morning star, spiked gauntlet and helmet. The spiked gauntlet counts as an additional hand weapon and a buckler. And no, your Heroes cannot learn to use it!

Skills: A Pit Fighter may choose from Combat, Speed and Strength skills when he gains a new skill.

Ogre bodyguard

80 gold crowns to hire +30 gold crowns upkeep

Ogres are large, brutish creatures, standing some ten feet tall, and all of it bone and muscle. For this reason they are much in demand as bodyguards and mercenaries, despite their lack of brains. A warband backed up by an Ogre makes a fearsome enemy, since Ogres are extremely dangerous fighters and a terrifying sight to behold when enraged. They happily accept any employer, as they are notoriously unbothered about who they fight for.

May be Hired: Any warband except Skaven may hire an Ogre Bodyguard.

Rating: An Ogre Bodyguard increases the warband's rating by +25 points, plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Ogre	6	3	2	4	4	3	3	2	7

Weapons/Armour: Either two swords, axes or clubs (or any mix of them), or a double-handed weapon (you may choose which). Ogres wear light armour.

SPECIAL RULES

Fear: Ogres are large, threatening creatures that cause *fear*. See the Psychology section for details.

Large Target: Ogres are Large Targets as defined in the shooting rules.

Skills: An Ogre may choose from Combat and Strength skills when he gains new skills.

Halfling scout

15 gold crowns to hire +5 gold crowns upkeep

Halflings are diminutive creatures, generally more concerned with the timing of their next meal (or two) than with military pursuits. They range from three to four feet tall, and are neither very strong nor tough, but are naturally good shots and steadfast in the face of danger. Some Halflings are more adventurous than others, however, and these bold spirits are much sought after by mercenary bands, for they are splendid archers, and excellent cooks to boot.

May be Hired: Any warband except Skaven, Undead and the Possessed may hire a Halfling Scout.

Rating: A Halfling Scout increases the warband's rating by +5 points plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Halfling	4	2	4	2	2	1	4	1	8

Equipment: Bow, dagger and a cooking pot (counts as a helmet).

SPECIAL RULES:

Cook: Halflings are renowned for their cooking skills. A warband with a Halfling Scout may increase its maximum size by +1, as warriors from all around are attracted by the smell of great food! Note that this does not increase the maximum number of Heroes you may have.

Skills: A Halfling may choose from Speed and Shooting skills when he gains a new skill.

Warlock

30 gold crowns to hire +15 gold crowns upkeep

Wizards, shamans, mystics, all these and more are associated with men who can wield the power of magic. All magic is potentially dangerous and originates from Chaos, so those blessed (or cursed) with the power of sorcery are hated and feared.

Still, it is not difficult to find employment if you are a wizard, for many are willing to take the risk of persecution. But hiring a Warlock does not only mean that you lose your gold – if the teachings of the Cult of Sigmar are to be believed, your soul is at risk as well...

May be Hired: Any warband except Witch Hunters and Sisters of Sigmar may hire a Warlock.

Rating: A Warlock increases the warband's rating by +16 points plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Warlock	4	2	2	3	3	1	4	1	8

Equipment: A Warlock carries a staff.

SPECIAL RULES:

Wizard: Warlocks are magicians and have two spells generated at random from the Lesser Magic list. See the Magic section for details.

Skills: Warlocks may choose skills from the Academic skills list, or they may randomly determine a new spell from the Lesser Magic spell list.

Freelancer

50 gold crowns to hire + 20 gold crowns upkeep

Just as warriors of the lower social orders can become mercenaries, squires or nobles may offer their skills for hire by becoming a Freelancer or 'robber knight'. Freelancers are often the younger sons of nobles, who have inherited little but their weapons, horse and armour. Having become disillusioned with their lot in life they have taken the only road available to them: that of a Hired Sword.

Financial considerations take precedence over the dictates of honour and chivalry. Many Freelancers have drifted to the shanty towns surrounding Mordheim, and offer their considerable strength to the highest bidders.

May be Hired: Mercenaries and Witch Hunters may hire Freelancers.

Rating: A Freelancer increases the warband's rating by +21 points plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Freelancer	4	4	3	4	3	1	4	1	7
Warhorse	8	3	0	3	3	1	3	1	5

Equipment: Heavy armour, shield, lance and sword. If you are using the optional rules for mounted models, a Freelancer rides a warhorse (and has the Ride Warhorse skill from the Blazing Saddles article). When mounted, the Freelancer has an armour saving throw of 3+. On foot his save is 4+.

Skills: A Freelancer may choose from Combat and Strength skills when he gains a new skill.

Elf ranger

40 gold crowns to hire + 20 gold crowns upkeep

Elves are a wondrous race: lithe, tall, beautiful, long-lived and magical. For the most part they are feared and distrusted by humans, though some live in the cities amongst men and offer their services as minstrels and archers in return for a high fee.

Though Elves become rarer in the Old World each year, there are still some roaming on the trackless paths of the Drakwald Forest and the Forest of Shadows.

Elves sensibly tend to avoid the ruins of Mordheim, for in the City of the Damned there is little to attract that fey and strange race, but sometimes they are hired by treasure hunters, for few can match their skill with a bow, or their inhuman quickness and agility. The senses of an Elf are much keener than any human's, and they make excellent scouts.

May be Hired: Mercenaries and Witch Hunters may hire Elf Rangers. Warbands which include Dwarfs may hire Elf Rangers, but must pay 40 gold crowns after each battle instead of 20.

Rating: An Elf Ranger increases the warband's rating by 12 points plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Elf Ranger	5	4	5	3	3	1	6	1	8

Equipment: Elf bow, sword and Elven cloak.

Skills: An Elf Ranger may choose from Shooting and Speed skills when he gains a new skill. In addition, there are several skills unique to Elf Rangers as detailed below, which he can choose instead of normal skills. Note that these special skills can only be acquired through experience. They are not possessed by a new recruit.

SPECIAL RULES

Seeker. When rolling on the Exploration chart, the Elf Ranger allows you to modify one dice roll by -1/+1.

Excellent Sight. Elves have eyesight unmatched by mere humans. The Elf Ranger spots Hidden enemies from two times as far away as other warriors (ie, twice his Initiative value in inches).

ELVEN SKILLS

Fey. Hostile magic spells will not affect the Elf on a D6 roll of 4+.

Luck. The Elf Ranger is blessed by Lileath, the Elven goddess of luck. Once per game he may re-roll any dice roll he makes (but not one made by other members of the warband).

Dwarf troll slayer

25 gold crowns to hire +10 gold crowns upkeep

Troll Slayers are members of the morbid Dwarf cult whose followers are obsessed with seeking an honourable death in combat. Having committed some unforgivable crime or been dishonoured in an irredeemable way, a Dwarf will forsake his home and wander off to die fighting the enemies of Dwarfkind.

Troll Slayers are insanely dangerous individuals, psychopathic and violent. However, there are few better fighters, so they are much sought after when warriors are needed.

Known as 'Hired Axes', Troll Slayers who come to Mordheim find plenty of opportunity to indulge their deathwish.

May be Hired: Mercenaries and Witch Hunters may hire a Dwarf Troll Slayer. Warbands that include Elves may hire Slayers, but must pay 20 gold crowns after each battle instead of 10 gold crowns. Dwarfs won't put up with weak pointy-eared folk unless they have to, or are adequately compensated for their sufferance.

Rating: A Dwarf Troll Slayer increases the warband's rating by 12 points plus 1 point for each Experience point he has.

Profile	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Troll Slayer	3	4	3	3	4	1	2	1	9

Weapons/Armour: Two axes or a double-handed axe (the hiring player may choose).

Skills: A Troll Slayer may choose from Combat and Strength skills when he gains a new skill. In addition, there are several skills unique to Dwarf Troll Slayers which he can have instead of normal skills when he gains a new skill.

SPECIAL RULES

Deathwish. Troll Slayers seek an honourable death in combat. They are completely immune to all psychology and will never need to test if they are fighting alone.

Hard to Kill. Troll Slayers are tough, resilient individuals who can only be taken *out of action* on a D6 roll of 6 instead of 5-6 when rolling on the Injury chart. Treat a roll of 5 as *stunned*.

Hard Head. Troll Slayers ignore the special rules for maces, clubs etc. They are not very easy individuals to knock out!

TROLL SLAYER SKILLS

Ferocious Charge. The Dwarf may double his attacks on the turn in which he charges. He will suffer a -1 to hit penalty on that turn.

Monster Slayer. The Troll Slayer always wounds any opponent on a D6 roll of 4+, regardless of Toughness, unless his own Strength (with weapon modifiers) would mean that a lower result than this is needed.

Berserker. The Dwarf may add +1 to his to hit rolls during the turn in which he charges.

This section details some of the strangest and most famous (or infamous) characters to be found in Mordheim and the outlying settlements. Occasionally, these warriors join forces with a warband (usually demanding wyrdstone or a bag of gold in payment).

The following characters (known as 'special characters') are hard to find and expensive to hire – you must be lucky and wealthy to attract their attention.

This list does not, by any means, include all the famous warriors and cold-hearted killers you could encounter in Mordheim. There are famous Dwarf gold hunters, Burgomeisters of the Merchants' Guild, Theodor, the marksman of Hochland, and many others. In fact we hope that the characters detailed here will inspire players to invent special characters of their own.

You can only ever have one of a particular special character in your warband. A warband may employ as many special characters as it likes – if it can afford them!

looking for special characters

After a battle, you can send any number of your Heroes to look for a special character. Only Heroes can look (Henchmen are rarely trustworthy enough). Heroes who went *out of action* in the last battle are unable to join the search because they are recovering from their wounds.

Heroes who are looking for a special character cannot look for rare items. Decide which special character you are seeking, and how many Heroes have been sent to look for him. Roll a D6 for each searcher. If any of the searchers rolls under his Initiative he has located the special character. You can, of course, only find one of a particular special character, no matter how many searchers roll under their Initiative.

hire fee

The warband must pay the *hire fee* for the special character when he is recruited, and after each battle he fights, including the first, you must pay an *upkeep fee*. These fees are indicated in the entries. This money comes from the warband's treasury in the same way as buying new weapons or recruiting new warriors. If you don't have enough gold to pay for the special character he leaves the warband.

experience, injuries and equipment

Special characters have their own equipment. Only they may use this equipment; it can't be given to other warriors. Furthermore, you cannot buy extra weapons or equipment for a special character.

Special characters do not earn Experience points, although they suffer serious injuries, just like Heroes, if they are taken *out of action*.

Each special character's description tells you how much to add to your warband's rating for including them (taking into account their experience and abilities).

Aenur, the sword of twilight

Many famous swordsmen have come to Mordheim to make their fortune, but few can match the terrifying reputation of the Elf swordsman Aenur. This mighty warrior was responsible for slaying the entire Possessed warband of Karl Zimmeran, and single-handedly cleansed the Rat Hole, a settlement that had been overrun by Beastmen.

Rumours about Aenur's origin abound. Elves usually avoid human settlements, and Mordheim in particular, but for some reason the tall, pale swordsman has stayed in the proximity of the ruined city for months.

Some say Aenur comes from beyond the Great Ocean, from the fabled Elven kingdoms, and that he is the captain of the legendary Order of Swordmasters. Others claim that he is a Wood Elf prince in exile. Aenur himself says little about his past and those who are wise do not question him.

Whenever a warband prepares an expedition to explore the inner city, there is a chance they may hear a sharp rap at the gate of their encampment – their unexpected visitor will be Aenur, offering his services to their leader.

If, indeed, Aenur seeks something in the grim ruins of Mordheim, no-one knows what this might be. Some say that he wishes to explore the Pit itself, and slay the enigmatic Shadow Lord, though such a task must surely be above even this mighty warrior.

Aenur is tall even for an Elf, and beneath his finely woven Elven cloak he wears armour of gleaming ithilmar. He carries a sword of immense size which is rumoured to have arcane properties. Certainly no-one who has been struck by it has ever lived to tell the tale.

Hire Fee: 150 gold crowns to hire.

May be Hired: Any warband except Skaven, Undead and the Possessed may hire Aenur.

Rating: Aenur increases the warband's rating by +100 points.

	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Aenur	5	8	4	4	3	2	7	3	8

Weapons/Armour: Aenur wears ithilmar armour, an Elven cloak and carries an enormous sword known as *Ienh-Khain*.

Skills: Aenur has the following skills: *Strike to Injure*, *Expert Swordsman*, *Step Aside*, *Sprint*, *Lightning Reflexes*, *Dodge* and *Mighty Blow*.

SPECIAL RULES

Invincible Swordsman. Aenur always hits his opponents on a roll of 2+ in hand-to-hand combat.

Wanderer. Aenur only ever stays with a warband for the duration of the battle. A warband who used Aenur in their last battle may not seek him out until they have fought at least one battle without him.

Ienh-Khain (the Hand of Khaine).

Ienh-Khain is an incredibly long single-edged sword, which

Aenur uses with consummate skill.

This sword allows

Aenur to parry,

adds +1 to his

Strength and

causes a

critical hit

on a roll

of 5-6

when

rolling

to

wound.

Johann the Knife

“Get your hands off me, brute! Let go of me, and I’ll tell you what I know. So, you seek Johann the Knife! Take my advice, friend, do not speak his name out loud. He does not like people talking about him in the street. What do you seek him for anyway? So, you’ve got a job for him! Well, why didn’t you say so before? I cannot say where you might find him, because I do not know myself. Who does? Anyway, no matter. When he hears word, he will find you soon enough! Ha! ha! It will cost you though, for he likes gold, does Johann. He knows this city – what’s left of it – like the back of his hand. If he can’t find someone, no-one can. He is like a shadow, he can go in and out of anywhere, unseen. He can also fight his way out of anywhere. No one can catch him.

As quick as lightning with a knife, he is!

No traces, all very

neat and

tidy. All I

need from

you is the

gold, and the

name. Johann

will do the

rest.”

Conversation
overheard in
Mordheim

Of the many cutthroats and assassins for hire that infest the settlements around Mordheim, Johann the Knife is the most famous. He exhibits his vocation as hired knife-fighter and assassin extraordinaire by the various lethal-looking daggers hanging from his belt, and the mean glint of his eyes. Johann wears dark leather gear, slightly out of fashion, which has never been washed (or so the barmaids say). His long face bears the scars of many a fight, and his unkempt hair is lank and greasy.

Johann’s purse is always heavy with gold, and he takes no trouble to hide it, since only a fool would try to steal it from him. Many have tried, and all have died... very quickly. The craftsmanship and quality of Johann’s daggers is beyond compare, as he has taken them from the bodies of the many wealthy, but unskilful, opponents he has despatched in vicious duels.

Hire Fee: 70 gold crowns to hire; +30 gold crowns upkeep cost. Johann is addicted to Crimson Shade, so you may hire him for one portion of Crimson Shade if you wish.

May be Hired: Any warband except Skaven, Undead and the Possessed may hire Johann.

Rating: Johann the Knife increases a warband’s rating by +60 points.

	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Johann	4	3	6	4	3	2	6	1	7

Weapons/Armour: Johann is armed with countless throwing knives and several long daggers (he always counts as having two swords in close combat). His weapons are always coated with Black Lotus and he may take Crimson Shade before a battle if you want him to.

SKILLS

Johann has the following skills: *Dodge*, *Scale Sheer Surfaces*, *Quick Shot*, *Eagle Eyes* and *Knife Fighter*.

SPECIAL RULES

Knife Fighter Extraordinaire: Johann has a deserved reputation for being the greatest knife-fighter in whole of the Empire. Unlike normal warriors, he can combine the *Knife Fighter* and *Quick Shot* skills (yes, he can throw six throwing knives in one turn if he does not move!).

Bertha Bestraufung, High matriarch of the sisterhood

MYears ago, Bertha sought refuge in the strict discipline and devotions of the Sisters of Sigmar. Only the warrior god of the Empire was worthy of her esteem. Only He was constant and faithful. And had not holy Sigmar, in truth, chosen her to be one of his handmaidens?

The pure blood of the Unberogens runs in Bertha's veins, as evinced by her long golden plaits and fierce blue eyes, which can freeze a Goblin at twenty paces with an icy glare. Even her voice commands authority, turning strong, hairy-thewed men into trembling wretches.

The Sisters look up to Bertha as an example of holy womanhood. She rose rapidly through the ranks of the Sisterhood, and on her deathbed the revered Matriarch Cassandra named Bertha her successor, new High Matriarch, and Abedissa of Sigmar's Rock.

Sometimes, as Bertha straps on her Gromril armour in the light of dawn, she reflects on the lost innocence of her youth. Then, angrily, she tightens the studded leather straps tightly over her iron-hard limbs and strides outside to spend hours practising with her great warhammers, preparing herself, as a bride of Sigmar should, for the day of battle.

Extract from the Tome of Heroes

Hire Fee: None. Bertha will come to the aid of any Sisters of Sigmar warband if they send one or more of their Heroines to look for her in the normal manner, rolling under their Initiative (representing their efforts to gain audience with the High Matriarch). If she does grant an audience, she might decide that her personal help is needed in the forthcoming battle. She will only come to the aid of a Sisters of Sigmar warband if their enemy has a higher warband rating. Consult the table below, and roll a D6 to see whether Bertha will aid the warband. A request for Bertha to aid the warband must be made for each battle you wish her to help the warband.

Difference in Warband Rating	Dice roll required
0-49	Nil
50-99	6+
100-149	5+
150-199	4+
200+	3+

	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Bertha	4	5	3	4	4	2	4	3	10

May be Hired: Bertha Bestraufung will only join Sisters of Sigmar warbands.

Rating: Bertha increases a warband's rating by +105 points.

Weapons/Armour: Bertha is armed with two Sigmarite warhammers, wears gromril armour, and carries a vial of blessed water and a holy relic.

SKILLS

Bertha has the following skills: *Mighty Blow*, *Unstoppable Charge* and *Righteous Fury*.

PRAYERS OF SIGMAR

Bertha knows all six Prayers of Sigmar.

SPECIAL RULES

High Matriarch. As the High Matriarch of the Sisters of Sigmar's Mercy, Bertha will automatically be the leader of any warband she joins.

Sigmar's Handmaiden.

Bertha is favoured above all other Sisters in the eyes of Sigmar. She gains +2 to all her rolls to see whether her Prayers of Sigmar are granted.

Veskit, high executioner of clan eshin

"It killed us all! We couldn't stop it, our weapons broke against its body... It was black, like a shadow, and it was moving so fast, cutting men to shreds left and right. We fought, yes we fought hard, and old Marcus even tried his trick with the oil flask. It was engulfed by flames and for a moment we thought we'd stopped it. No way, it came out of the fire, still ablaze. It was as if it didn't care! That was too much and those left of us ran for it. Still it followed us, on and on, relentless and merciless. There was no escaping, no biding, its red eye could always spot you. Oh that eye... that eye..."

Last words of Fritz Huber at the Inn of the Red Moon,

Veskit was already a talented clan Eshin Assassin when he was entrusted with his most difficult mission. He was hired by Clan Skryre to free one of their oldest and most experienced Warlocks who was being held hostage by a rival clan.

Veskit managed to take the prisoner back, fighting his way through the guards, but at a very high cost. He suffered terrible wounds and would have certainly died, but the Nightmaster of Clan Eshin made a pact with the Warlock Engineers. The Skaven scientist-sorcerers replaced various parts of Veskit's body with their part technological, part magical implants and made him into a walking arsenal of deadly weapons. Veskit is now more a machine than a living thing, and his thirst for killing has become almost uncontrollable.

When news of the wyrdstone came to the hidden fortress of Clan Eshin, the Nightmaster sent Veskit to Mordheim to deter the man-things from exploring the city, which rightfully belonged to the Skaven. From that day on, many adventurers have met their end in the dark allies of Mordheim. Veskit's unblinking eye misses nothing, and those he hunts on the streets of Mordheim never return to the Gargoyle Gate.

Hire Fee: 80 gold crowns to hire; +35 gold crowns upkeep cost.

May be Hired: Veskit may only be hired by Skaven warbands.

Rating: Veskit increases the warband's rating by +70 points.

	M	WS	BS	S	T	W	I	A	Ld
Veskit	5	5	4	4	4	2	5	4	8

Weapons/Armour: Eshin Fighting Claws (the extra attack is included in his profile). Each Fighting Claw incorporates an in-built warplack pistol, so Veskit can shoot in every turn, and he fights in close combat with Strength 5 and a save modifier of -3 (note that he can still parry twice with his claws!).

SPECIAL RULES

Unfeeling. Veskit is a cold, calculating killing machine, and feels few of the emotions that living things do. He is therefore immune to all psychology.

No Pain. Veskit ignores *knocked down* and *stunned* results on the Injury chart. He must lose his last wound and be taken *out of action* before he is removed from battle.

Unblinking Eye. Thanks to the sorcerous devices built by the Warlock Engineers of Clan Skryre, Veskit can spot hidden enemies within twice his Initiative value in inches.

Metallic Body. These give Veskit his high Toughness and a 3+ armour save.